

MAT 4233 — Weekly Schedule

Modern Abstract Algebra · Fall 2026 · UT San Antonio

Texts

Primary text

- **LiZh** — Li & Zhao, *Introduction to Abstract Algebra*, Les Ulis: EDP Sciences, 2022. ISBN 978-2-7598-2915-6. DOI: 10.1051/978-2-7598-2916-3

Supplementary reading

- **Childs** — Childs, *A Concrete Introduction to Higher Algebra*, 3rd ed., Springer, 2009. ISBN 978-0-387-74527-5. DOI: 10.1007/978-0-387-74725-5
- **Rosebrock** — Rosebrock, *Visual Group Theory*, Springer, 2024. ISBN 978-3-662-69364-3. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-662-69365-0
- **Beardon** — Beardon, *Algebra and Geometry*, Cambridge University Press, 2005. ISBN 978-0-521-81362-4. DOI: 10.1017/CBO9780511800436

Handouts & papers

- **Conrad** — Conrad, *The Gaussian Integers*

Schedule

Date	Topic	Reading
Thu 20 Aug	Lecture — Course launch. The integers: division algorithm, gcd, Bezout	Childs Ch. 3
Tue 25 Aug	Lecture — Congruence and the ring $\mathbb{Z}_n$	Childs Ch. 5 & 6
Thu 27 Aug	Lecture — Binary operations; Cayley tables; isomorphic binary structures	LiZh §1.1-1.2
Tue 1 Sep	Lecture — Plane isometries and finite symmetry groups: every one is cyclic or dihedral	Rosebrock Ch. 1; Beardon §3.1-3.4; Handout: Complex geometry (encrypted; passphrase on Canvas)
Thu 3 Sep	Lecture — Groups: axioms and first properties	LiZh §1.3
Tue 8 Sep	Q&A (Due: Set 1)	
Thu 10 Sep	Lecture — Subgroups; examples	LiZh §1.4
Tue 15 Sep	Lecture — Cyclic groups; the order of an element; generators	LiZh §1.5
Thu 17 Sep	Lecture — Generating sets	LiZh §1.6
Tue 22 Sep	Lecture — Permutation groups; cycle notation; Cayley's theorem	LiZh §2.1
Thu 24 Sep	Lecture — Alternating groups; the sign of a permutation; A_4 and the tetrahedron	LiZh §2.2
Tue 29 Sep	Q&A (Due: Set 2)	
Thu 1 Oct	Exam — Midterm Exam 1 — Sets 1 and 2	
Tue 6 Oct	Lecture — Cosets; Lagrange's theorem; index	LiZh §3.1
Thu 8 Oct	Lecture — Homomorphisms: kernel, image, and first properties	LiZh §3.3
Thu 15 Oct	Lecture — Normal subgroups; quotient groups	LiZh §3.4

Date	Topic	Reading
Tue 20 Oct	Lecture — The fundamental homomorphism theorem; groups of small order	LiZh §3.4
Thu 22 Oct	Lecture — Rings and subrings; units and zero divisors	LiZh §4.1
Tue 27 Oct	Q&A (Due: Set 3)	
Thu 29 Oct	Lecture — Integral domains and fields; Euler's and Fermat's theorems	LiZh §4.2; LiZh §4.6
Tue 3 Nov	Lecture — Ring homomorphisms, ideals and quotient rings; fundamental homomorphism theorem	LiZh §4.5
Thu 5 Nov	Lecture — Ideal theory: principal, prime and maximal ideals	LiZh §4.7
Tue 10 Nov	Lecture — Irreducibles and primes; unique factorization domains; principal ideal domains	LiZh §5.1-5.2
Thu 12 Nov	Lecture — Euclidean domains; the Euclidean algorithm in $\mathbb{Z}$ and in $k[x]$	LiZh §5.3
Tue 17 Nov	Lecture — Multiplicative norms; the Gaussian integers $\mathbb{Z}[i]$; Fermat's Two Squares theorem	LiZh §5.5; Conrad (statements and examples; proofs optional)
Thu 19 Nov	Q&A (Due: Set 4)	
Tue 24 Nov	Lecture — Sums of three and four squares; $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{-5}]$ and the failure of unique factorization	Instructor notes
Tue 1 Dec	<i>Review</i> — Review — the exam pool	
Thu 3 Dec	Exam — Midterm Exam 2 — Sets 3 and 4	